

The Department of Defense and its relationship with Legislators

PS 699: Independent Study

Fatima Ali

Contents

Data	1
Top 10 Legislators who wrote to DoD combined	1
Many letters to DOD are cosigned	12
Limitations	14
References	14

Data

In all, we have 8005 letters received by the DoD marked “congressional” since 2003. All of these are from Members of the U.S. Congress.

```
load(here("data/all_contacts.RData"))
# one obs per member per letter for all agencies
d <- all_contacts %>% filter(str_detect(agency, "DOD")) %>% filter(!(last_name == "GRASSLEY"& party == "R"))
#would Grassley be considered a good outlier??
# 2007-2017 Data Points
```

Top 10 Legislators who wrote to DoD combined

```
# top overall
d %>% count(bioname,party,cqlabel, sort = T) %>% top_n(10, n) %>% kable(caption = "Legislators who wrote to DoD")
```

Table 1: Legislators who wrote the most letters to DOD

bioname	party	cqlabel	n
McCAIN, John Sidney, III	(R)	(AZ)	116
FORBES, J. Randy	(R)	(VA-04)	86

bioname	party	cqlabel	n
NELSON, Clarence William (Bill)	(D)	(FL)	84
BURR, Richard M.	(R)	(NC)	75
McCASKILL, Claire	(D)	(MO)	70
TOOMEY, Patrick Joseph	(R)	(PA)	60
WITTMAN, Robert J.	(R)	(VA-01)	60
BOOZMAN, John	(R)	(AR)	59
HUNTER, Duncan Duane	(R)	(CA-50)	59
PELOSI, Nancy	(D)	(CA-08)	59

##FILTER OUT NA??

```
d %>% count(TYPE, sort = T) %>% top_n(10, n) %>% kable(caption = "Most Common Policy Areas")
```

Table 2: Most Common Policy Areas

TYPE	n
1	3779
NA	3326
5	148
6	88
0	43
2	35
3	25
4	3

##Types of Policy each member dealt with

```
d %>% count(bioname, party, TYPE, cqlabel, sort = T) %>% top_n(10, n) %>% kable(caption = "Legislators w
```

Table 3: Legislators who wrote the most letters to DOD

bioname	party	TYPE	cqlabel	n
FORBES, J. Randy	(R)	NA	(VA-04)	58
McCAIN, John Sidney, III	(R)	NA	(AZ)	58
McCASKILL, Claire	(D)	NA	(MO)	52
NELSON, Clarence William (Bill)	(D)	1	(FL)	50
BOOZMAN, John	(R)	1	(AR)	48
McCAIN, John Sidney, III	(R)	1	(AZ)	46
WEBB, James H. (Jim)	(D)	NA	(VA)	45
PELOSI, Nancy	(D)	6	(CA-08)	43
TOOMEY, Patrick Joseph	(R)	1	(PA)	40
BURR, Richard M.	(R)	1	(NC)	38

##COULD ANYTHING BE DONE HERE

most with a given position

```
# d %>% count(bioname, party, cqlabel, letter_position, sort = T) %>% filter(letter_position != "Other")
```

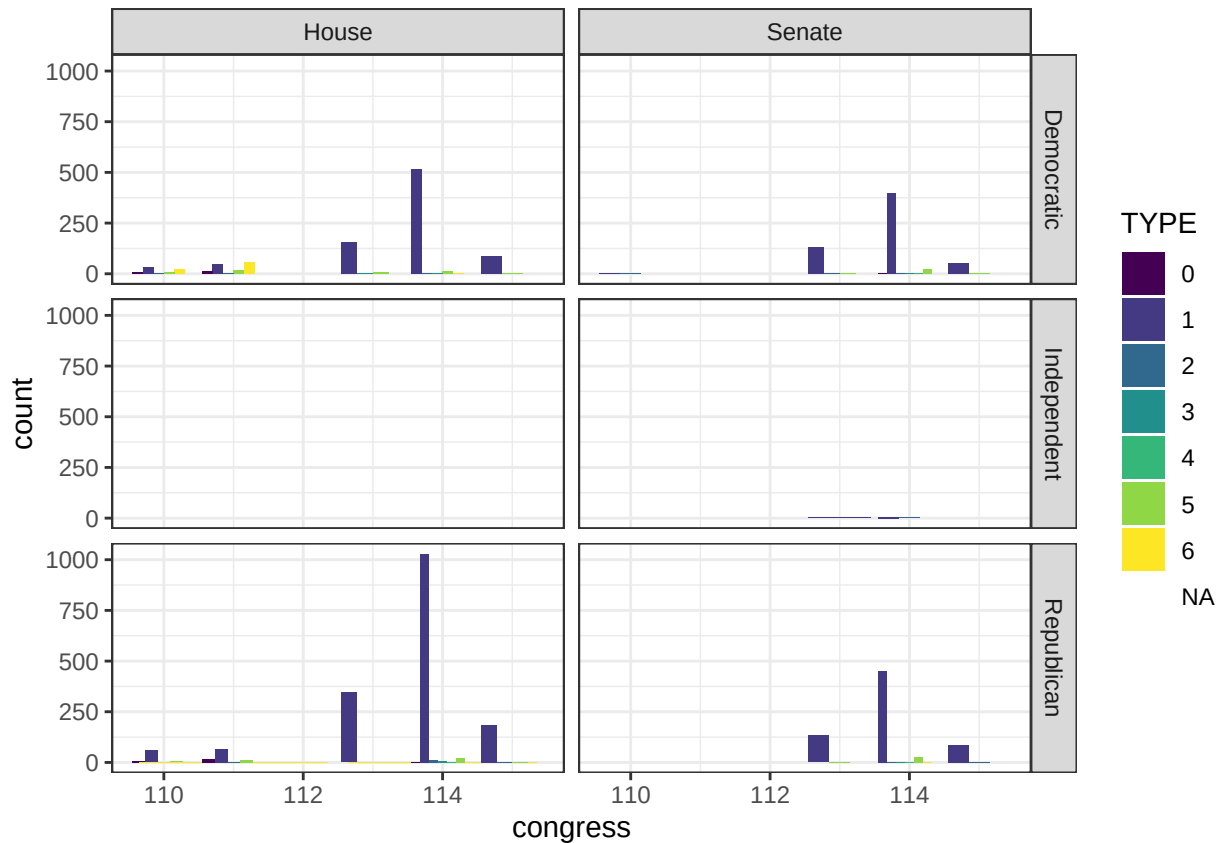
```
# most with a given position in a cycle
d %>% count(bioname, party, cqlabel, TYPE, congress, sort = T) %>% filter(TYPE != "Other") %>% top_n(10)
```

Table 4: Most frequent letter positions for a given legislator in a cycle

bioname	party	cqlabel	TYPE	congress	n
NELSON, Clarence William (Bill)	(D)	(FL)	1	114	39
BOOZMAN, John	(R)	(AR)	1	114	37
TOOMEY, Patrick Joseph	(R)	(PA)	1	114	32
BURR, Richard M.	(R)	(NC)	1	114	30
PELOSI, Nancy	(D)	(CA-08)	6	111	29
OBEY, David Ross	(D)	(WI-07)	6	111	28
KAINE, Timothy Michael (Tim)	(D)	(VA)	1	114	26
MURRAY, Patty	(D)	(WA)	1	114	25
RIGELL, E. Scott	(R)	(VA-02)	1	114	25
DAVIS, Susan A.	(D)	(CA-53)	1	114	24
McCAIN, John Sidney, III	(R)	(AZ)	1	114	24

```
#
# # d %>% filter(str_detect(SUBJECT, "forwards")) %>% add_count(bioname, sort = T) %>% top_n(1, n) %>%
#
d %>%
  ggplot() +
  aes(x = congress, fill = TYPE) +
  geom_bar(position = "dodge") +
  facet_grid(party_name ~ chamber)
```

```
## Warning: position_dodge requires non-overlapping x intervals
```



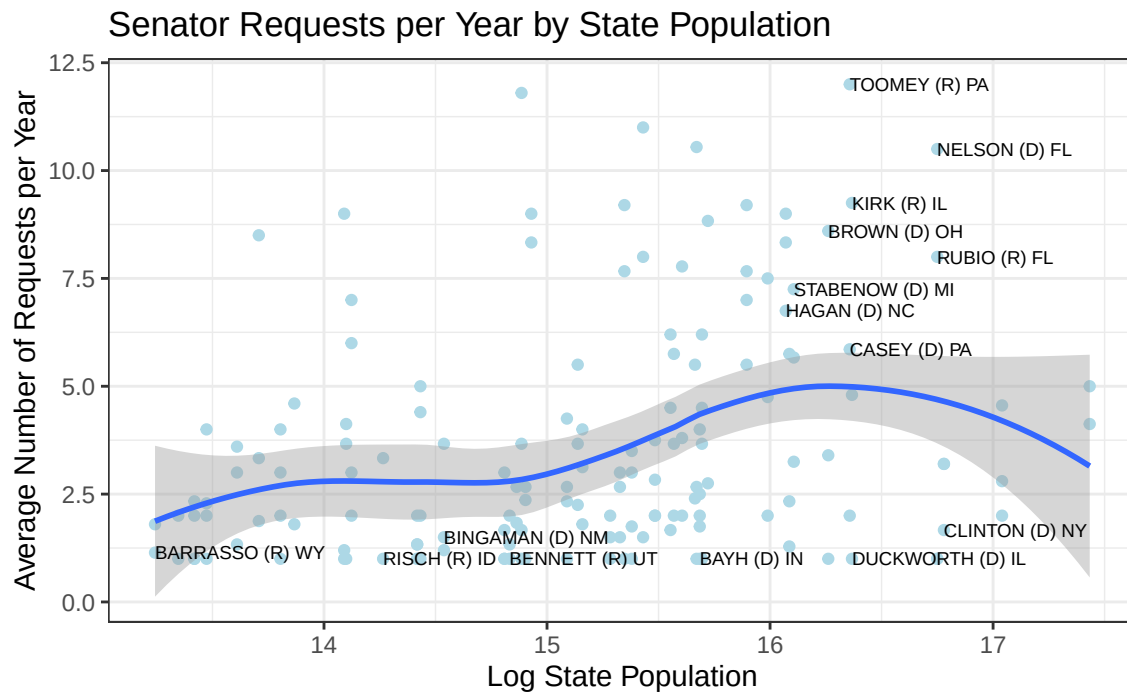
###Senators and Veteran Population ###HELP WITH THIS #Representative per district??

```
# d %>%
#   filter(chamber == "Senate") %>%
#     group_by(member_state, year, vetpop2010) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
#     group_by(member_state, vetpop2010) %>% summarise(mean = mean(n)) %>% ungroup() %>%
#   ggplot() +
#     geom_point(aes(x = log(vetpop2010), y = mean), color = "light blue") +
#     geom_smooth(aes(x = log(vetpop2010), y = mean)) +
#     geom_text(aes(x = log(vetpop2010),
#                   y = mean,
#                   label = ifelse(mean > mean(mean)*1.5 | mean < mean(mean)*0.5,
#                                 member_state, "")),
#               check_overlap = TRUE,
#               size = 2.5,
#               hjust = 0) +
#   theme_bw() +
#   labs(title = "Senator Requests per Year by State Population",
#        x = "Log State Population",
#        y = "Average Number of Requests per Year")
```

Senators vs. state population

```
d %>%
  filter(chamber == "Senate") %>%
  group_by(member_state, year, pop2010) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
  group_by(member_state, pop2010) %>% summarise(mean = mean(n)) %>% ungroup() %>%
  ggplot() +
  geom_point(aes(x = log(pop2010), y = mean), color = "light blue") +
  geom_smooth(aes(x = log(pop2010), y = mean)) +
  geom_text(aes(x = log(pop2010),
    y = mean,
    label = ifelse(mean > mean(mean)*1.5 | mean < mean(mean)*0.5,
      member_state, ""),
    check_overlap = TRUE,
    size = 2.5,
    hjust = 0) +
  theme_bw() +
  labs(title = "Senator Requests per Year by State Population",
    x = "Log State Population",
    y = "Average Number of Requests per Year")
```

```
## `geom_smooth()` using method = 'loess' and formula 'y ~ x'
```

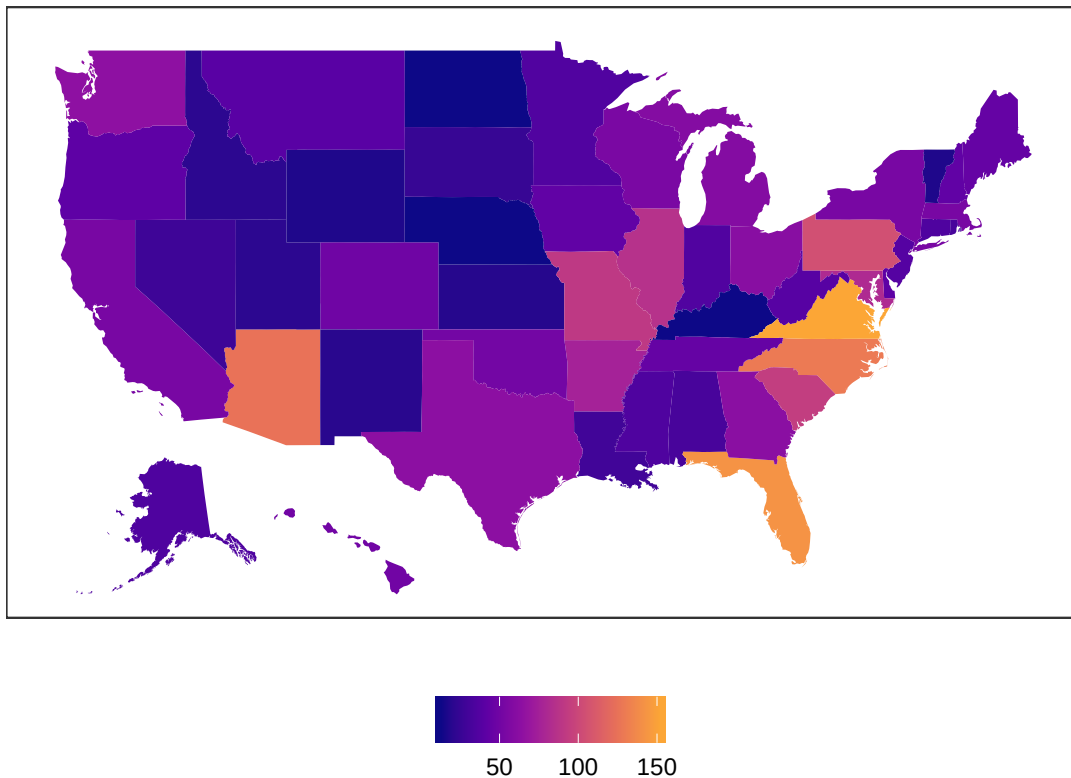


```
Chamber = "Senate"
```

```
d %>%
  ungroup() %>%
  filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
  group_by(state) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
  # map_id creates the aesthetic mapping to the state name column
  ggplot() +
```

```
# map points to the fifty_states shape data
geom_map(aes(map_id = state, fill = n), map = fifty_states) +
expand_limits(x = fifty_states$long, y = fifty_states$lat) +
coord_map() +
scale_x_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
scale_y_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
labs(x = "", y = "", title = paste("Total Number of Contacts from members of the", Chamber)) +
scale_fill_viridis_c(option = "C", end = .8) +
theme(legend.position = "bottom", legend.title = element_blank(),
      panel.background = element_blank()) # + facet_grid(. ~ Constituent)
```

Total Number of Contacts from members of the Senate



##What on earth is happening here?

```
# d %>%
#   ungroup() %>%
#   filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
#   group_by(state, pop2010) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>% ungroup() %>%
#   mutate(Per_Capita = n/pop2010*1000000) %>%
#   # map_id creates the aesthetic mapping to the state name column in your data
#   ggplot() +
#   # map points to the fifty_states shape data
#   geom_map(aes(map_id = state, fill = Per_Capita), map = fifty_states) +
#   expand_limits(x = fifty_states$long, y = fifty_states$lat) +
#   coord_map() +
#   scale_x_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
```

```

#   scale_y_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
#   labs(x = "", y = "", title = paste("Contacts Per hundred thousand Residents from Members of the", C
#   scale_fill_viridis_c(option = "C", end = .8) +
#   theme(legend.position = "bottom",
#         legend.title = element_blank() )#+facet_grid(. ~ Constituent)

# d %>%
#   mutate(Per_Capita = n/pop2010*1000000) %>% ##FIXME non-numeric argument to binary operator
#   # map_id creates the aesthetic mapping to the state name column in your data
#   ggplot() +
#   # map points to the fifty_states shape data
#   geom_map(aes(map_id = state, fill = Per_Capita), map = fifty_states) +
#   expand_limits(x = fifty_states$long, y = fifty_states$lat) +
#   coord_map() +
#   scale_x_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
#   scale_y_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
#   labs(x = "", y = "", title = paste("Contacts Per hundred thousand Residents from Members of the", C
#   scale_fill_viridis_c(option = "C", end = .8) +
#   theme(legend.position = "bottom",
#         legend.title = element_blank() )+
#   facet_grid(. ~ Constituent)

```

##House Contacts per State

##Would this be relevantt??

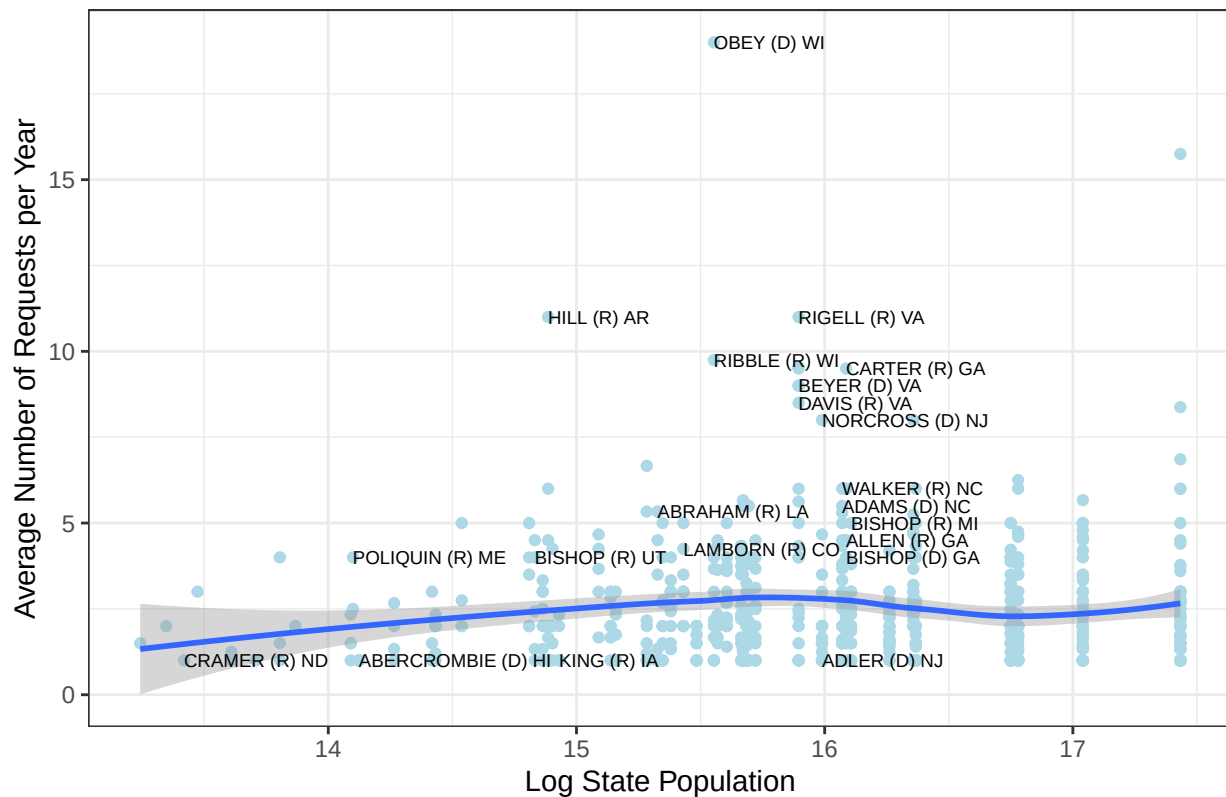
```

d %>%
  filter(chamber == "House") %>%
  group_by(member_state, year, pop2010) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
  group_by(member_state, pop2010) %>% summarise(mean = mean(n)) %>% ungroup() %>%
  ggplot() +
  geom_point(aes(x = log(pop2010), y = mean), color = "light blue") +
  geom_smooth(aes(x = log(pop2010), y = mean)) +
  geom_text(aes(x = log(pop2010),
                y = mean,
                label = ifelse(mean > mean(mean)*1.5 | mean < mean(mean)*0.5,
                              member_state, "")),
            check_overlap = TRUE,
            size = 2.5,
            hjust = 0) +
  theme_bw() +
  labs(title = "House Requests per Year by State Population",
       x = "Log State Population",
       y = "Average Number of Requests per Year")

```

`geom\_smooth()` using method = 'loess' and formula 'y ~ x'

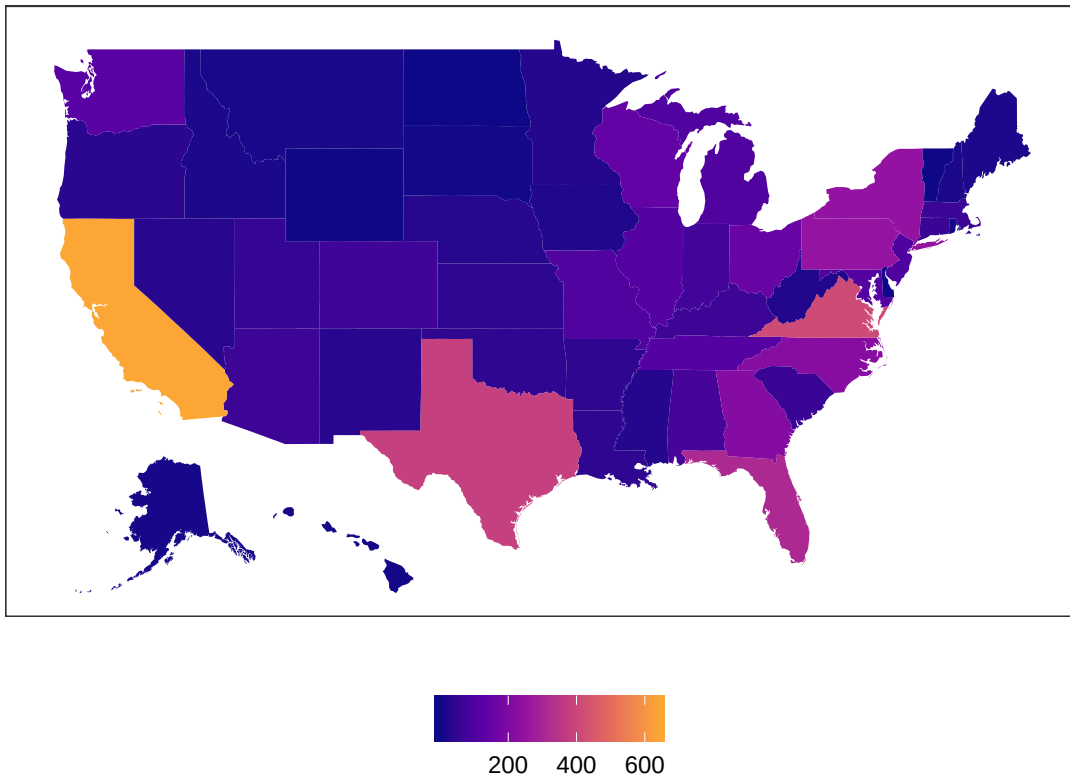
House Requests per Year by State Population



```
Chamber = "House"
```

```
d %>%
  ungroup() %>%
  filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
  group_by(state) %>% summarise(n = n()) %>%
  # map_id creates the aesthetic mapping to the state name column
  ggplot() +
  # map points to the fifty_states shape data
  geom_map(aes(map_id = state, fill = n), map = fifty_states) +
  expand_limits(x = fifty_states$long, y = fifty_states$lat) +
  coord_map() +
  scale_x_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
  scale_y_continuous(breaks = NULL) +
  labs(x = "", y = "", title = paste("Total Number of Contacts from members of the", Chamber)) +
  scale_fill_viridis_c(option = "C", end = .8) +
  theme(legend.position = "bottom", legend.title = element_blank(),
        panel.background = element_blank()) # + facet_grid(. ~ Constituent)
```


Total Number of Contacts from members of the House

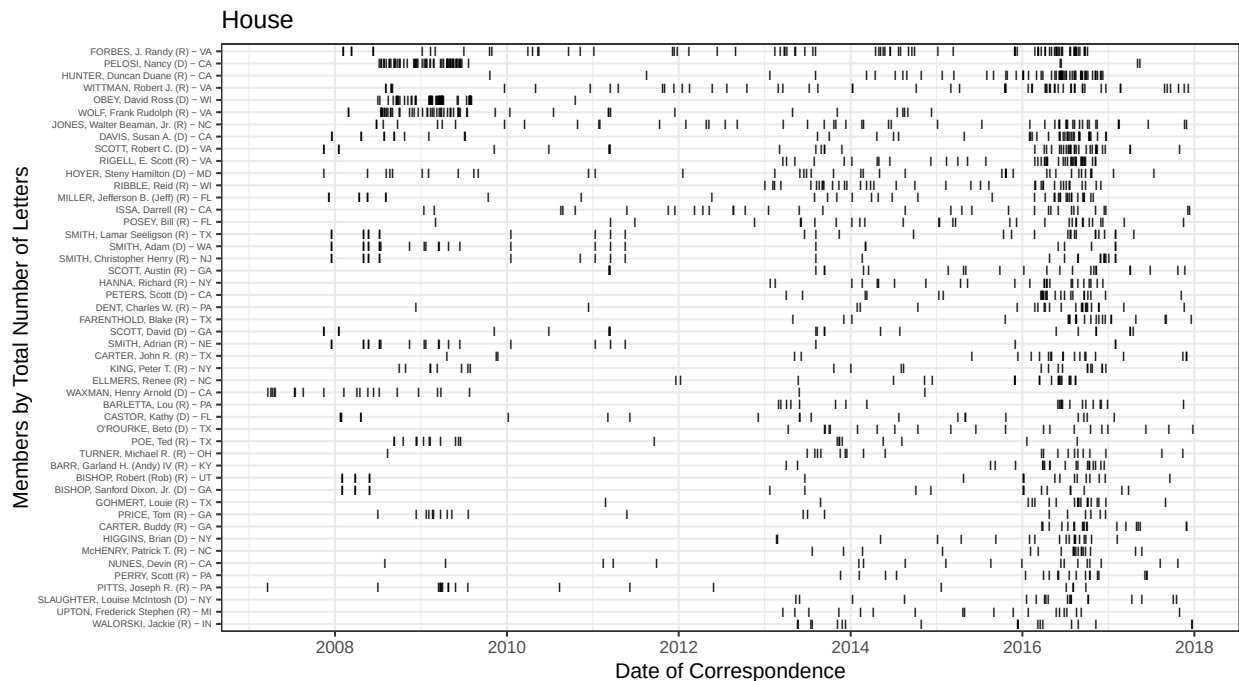


Members who contact DOD more than average:

```
# barcode plot of committee members

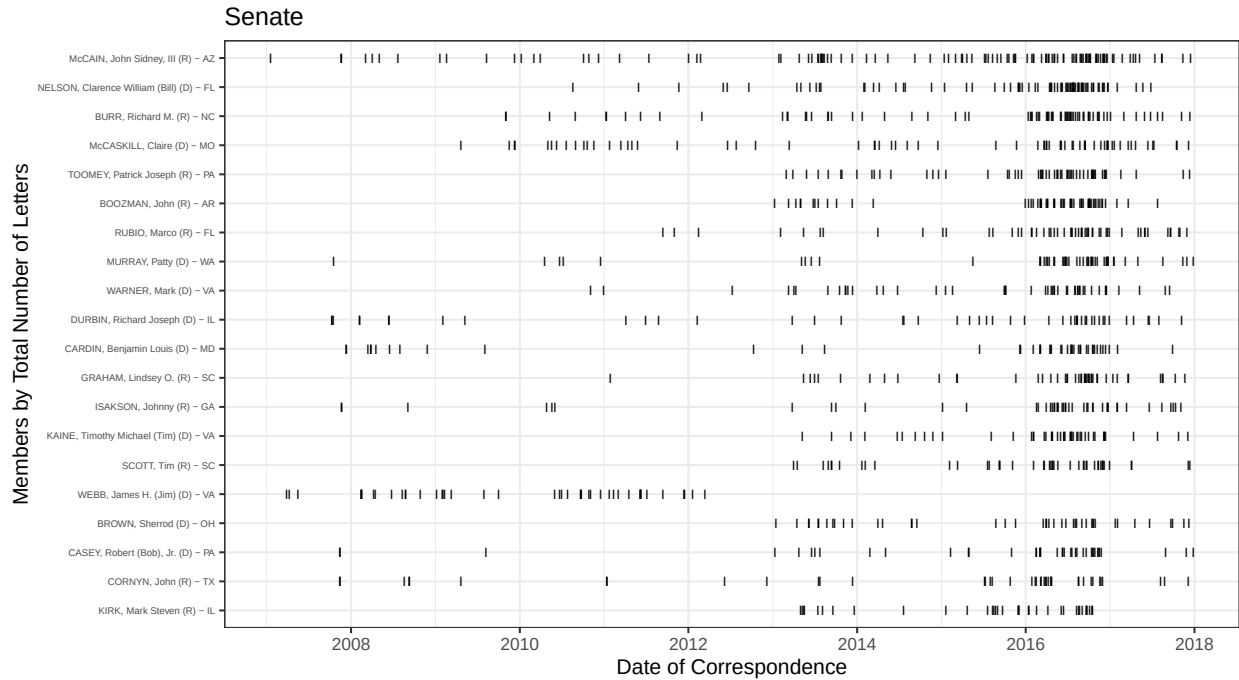
# member by year by agency
d %>%
  filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
  group_by(name_state) %>% mutate(n = n()) %>% ungroup() %>%
  filter(n > mean(n)) %>%
  ggplot() +
  geom_point(
    aes(x = DATE,
        y = reorder(name_state, n) ),
    # alpha = .6,
    shape = 73,
    size=2
  ) +
  labs(title = paste(Chamber),
       y = paste("Members by", "Total Number of Letters"),
       x = "Date of Correspondence" ) +
  theme(
    legend.title = element_blank(),
```

```
axis.text.y = element_text(size=5)
) +
guides(fill=guide_legend(ncol=1))
```



```
Chamber <- "Senate" # "Senate"

# member by year by agency
d %>%
  filter(chamber == Chamber) %>%
  group_by(name_state) %>% mutate(n = n()) %>% ungroup() %>%
  filter(n > mean(n)) %>%
  ggplot() +
  geom_point(
    aes(x = DATE,
        y = reorder(name_state, n) ),
    # alpha = .6,
    shape = 73,
    size=2
  ) +
  labs(title = paste(Chamber),
       y = paste("Members by", "Total Number of Letters"),
       x = "Date of Correspondence" ) +
  theme(
    legend.title = element_blank(),
    axis.text.y = element_text(size=5)
  ) +
  guides(fill=guide_legend(ncol=1))
```



Members who contact DOD more, relative to other agencies:

```
chamber <- "Senate" # "Senate" #why does it say False?
```

```
all_contacts %>%
  filter(chamber == "Senate") %>% #
  mutate(DOD = agency == "DOD") %>%
  group_by(chamber, DOD, name_state, state) %>%
  summarise(n = n() ) %>%
  ungroup() %>%
  #spread(key = "DOD", value = n) %>%
  top_n(10, n) %>%
  knitr::kable()
```

chamber	DOD	name_state	state	n
Senate	FALSE	WARNER, Mark (D) - VA	virginia	2811
Senate	FALSE	SCHUMER, Charles Ellis (Chuck) (D) - NY	new york	5561
Senate	FALSE	NELSON, Clarence William (Bill) (D) - FL	florida	5154
Senate	FALSE	MIKULSKI, Barbara Ann (D) - MD	maryland	3382
Senate	FALSE	McCAIN, John Sidney, III (R) - AZ	arizona	4300
Senate	FALSE	GRASSLEY, Charles Ernest (R) - IA	iowa	3763
Senate	FALSE	GILLIBRAND, Kirsten (D) - NY	new york	3648
Senate	FALSE	FEINSTEIN, Dianne (D) - CA	california	2867
Senate	FALSE	DURBIN, Richard Joseph (D) - IL	illinois	3010
Senate	FALSE	CORNYN, John (R) - TX	texas	3125

```

# mutate(ShareToDOD = round(`TRUE`/(`TRUE`+`FALSE`),2) ) %>%
# arrange(~ShareToDOD) %>%
# mutate(total = `TRUE` + `FALSE`) %>%
# select(name_state, chamber, total, ShareToDOD) %>%
# filter(ShareToDOD>.3) %>%

chamber <- "House"

all_contacts %>%
  filter(chamber == "House") %>% #why is this working this way??
  mutate(DOD = agency == "DOD$") %>%
  group_by(chamber, DOD, name_state, state) %>%
  summarise(n = n() ) %>%
  ungroup() %>%
  #spread(key = "DOD", value = n) %>%
  top_n(10, n) %>%
  knitr::kable()

```

chamber	DOD	name_state	state	n
House	FALSE	WOLF, Frank Rudolph (R) - VA	virginia	2574
House	FALSE	VISCLOSKY, Peter (D) - IN	indiana	1264
House	FALSE	VAN HOLLEN, Christopher (D) - MD	maryland	1303
House	FALSE	THOMPSON, Bennie (D) - MS	mississippi	1373
House	FALSE	SHIMKUS, John M. (R) - IL	illinois	1759
House	FALSE	PALLONE, Frank, Jr. (D) - NJ	new jersey	1149
House	FALSE	McCAUL, Michael T. (R) - TX	texas	1944
House	FALSE	HOYER, Steny Hamilton (D) - MD	maryland	1197
House	FALSE	GOODLATTE, Robert William (R) - VA	virginia	1566
House	FALSE	DENT, Charles W. (R) - PA	pennsylvania	1297

Members who contact FERC more in a Congress, relative to other agencies

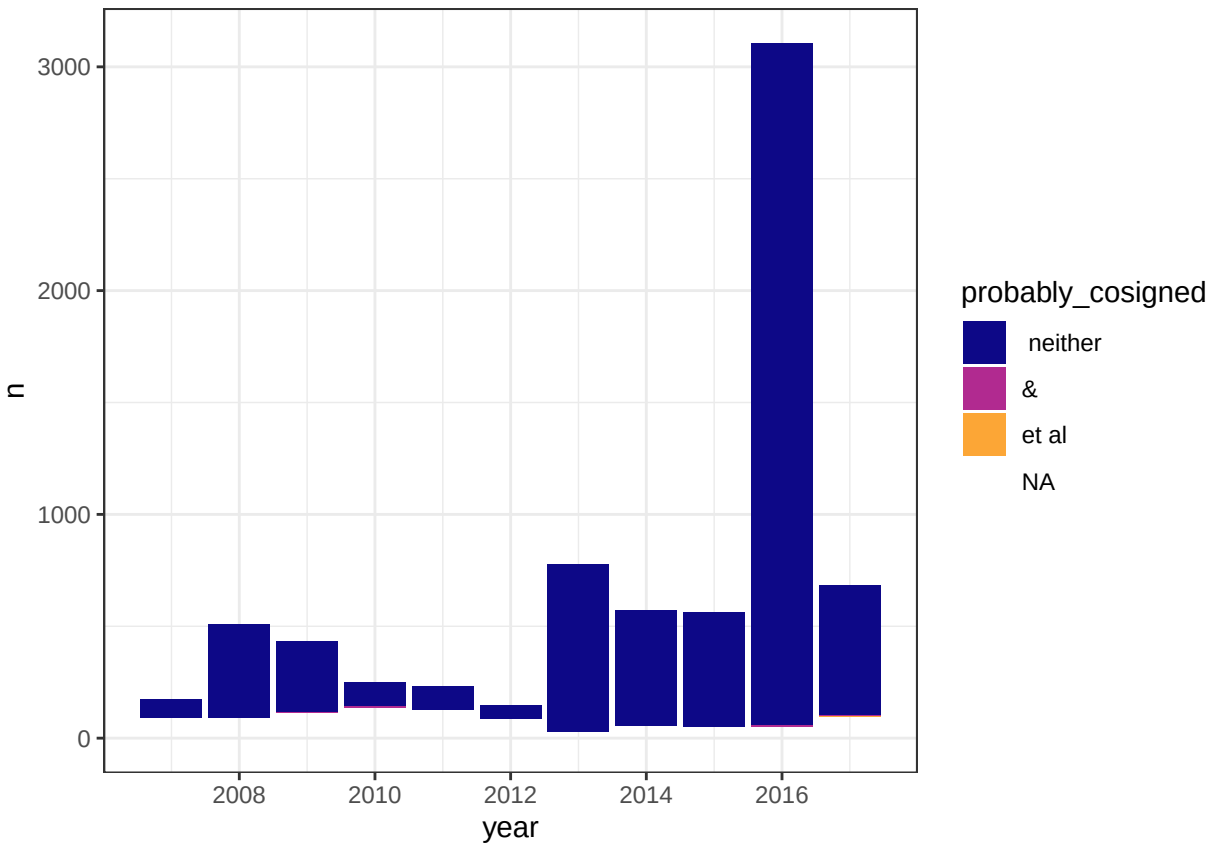
Many letters to DOD are cosigned

#A rough under-estimate based on whether “et al” or “&” appears in the summary: # INVESTIGATE

```

d %>%
  group_by(ID) %>%
  mutate(probably_cosigned = ifelse(str_detect(SUBJECT, "et al"), "et al",
                                     ifelse(str_detect(SUBJECT, "&"), "&", " neither"))) %>%
  group_by(year, probably_cosigned) %>%
  tally %>%
  ggplot() +
  aes(x = year, y = n, fill = probably_cosigned) +
  geom_col() +
  scale_fill_viridis_d(option = "C", end = .8)

```



##How to fix this committee Code

```
# d %>%
# mutate(chair = str_remove(chair, "[0-9]* | ^NA "),
#         committee = paste(chamber, committees))%>%
# dplyr::select(committee, position, chair, DATE, assigneddate, terminationdate) %>%
# distinct() %>%
# filter(str_detect(committee, "ENERGY$|ENVIRONMENT|NATURAL")) %>%
# mutate(position = ifelse(position == "Other", NA, position)) %>%
# #filter(!is.na(position), chair_since_2007 == T) %>%
# drop_na(chair) %>%
# dplyr::select(DATE, chair, position, assigneddate, terminationdate, committee) %>%
# distinct() %>%
# ggplot() +
# geom_point(
#   aes(x = DATE,
#       y = chair),
#   shape = 73,
#   size=2
# ) +
# geom_segment(aes(y = chair, yend = chair,
#                 x = date, xend = date,
#                 linetype = factor(position)),
#             position = position_nudge(y = -0.3)) +
# labs(title = paste("Letters to FERC from Committee Leadership"),
#      y = "",
```

```
#      x = "",
#      linetype = "Leadership position") +
# scale_y_discrete(position = "right") +
# theme(
#   strip.text.y = element_text(angle = 180, size = 5),
#   # legend.title = element_blank(),
#   axis.text.y = element_text(size=5),
#   axis.text.x = element_text(angle = 0)
# ) +
# facet_grid(committee ~ ., scales = "free_y", space = "free_y", switch = "both")
```

Limitations

Throughout the course of this independent study, there were a few challenges and limitations I faced.

References

- Amos A. Jordan, William J. Taylor, Jr. and Michael J. Mazar. 2009. , American National Security (Baltimore: Johns Hopkins University Press, 2009)
- Costa, Mia. 2020. "Citizen Evaluations of Legislator–Constituent Communication." *British Journal of Political Science*: 1–8.
- John Kingdon. 1973. Congressmen’s voting decisions.
- Keith T. Poole and Howard Rosenthal. 2007. *Ideology and Congress*. Transaction Publishers.
- Kingdon, John W. "Models of Legislative Voting." *The Journal of Politics*, vol. 39, no. 3, 1977, pp. 563–595. JSTOR, www.jstor.org/stable/2129644. Accessed 22 Jan. 2020.
- Nolan M. McCarty, Keith T. Poole, and Howard Rosenthal. 2006. *Polarized America: The dance of ideology and unequal riches*, MIT Press.
- David W. Rohde. 1991. *Parties and leaders in the post-reform House of Representatives*, University of Chicago Press.
- Fenno, Richard F., "U.S. House Members in Their Constituencies: An Exploration." *American Political Science Review* 71 (3, 1977): 883-917.
- Fenno, Richard F., *The Challenge of Congressional Representation* (Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press, 2013), 138-184.
- Congressional Procedures and the Policy Analysis, by Walter J. Oleszek, Congressional Quarterly Press, Ninth Edition, 2013
- Laurance, Edward J. "The Changing Role of Congress in Defense Policy-Making." *The Journal of Conflict Resolution*, vol. 20, no. 2, 1976, pp. 213–253. JSTOR, www.jstor.org/stable/173398. Accessed 22 Jan. 2020.
- Lindsay, James M., and Randall B. Ripley. "How Congress Influences Foreign and Defense Policy." *Bulletin of the American Academy of Arts and Sciences*, vol. 47, no. 6, 1994, pp. 7–32. JSTOR, www.jstor.org/stable/3824424. Accessed 22 Jan. 2020.
- Lindsay, James M., and Randall B. Ripley (1992). Foreign and Defense Policy in Congress: A Research Agenda for the 1990s. *Legislative Studies Quarterly* 417–449.
- Lowande, K. (2018). Who Polices the Administrative State? *American Political Science Review* 874–890.
- Lowande, Kenneth (2018). Politicization and Responsiveness in Executive Agencies. *Journal of Politics*.

Powell, Eleanor Neff and Justin Grimmer (2016). Money in Exile: Campaign Contributions and Committee Access. *The Journal of Politics* 78(4) 974–88.

Reif, Kingston (2017). Congress Rewrites Missile Defense Policy. *Arms Control Today*, 47 40–42.

Ritchie, Melinda N (2017). Back-Channel Representation: A Study of the Strategic Communication of Senators with the US Department of Labor. *Journal of Politics*.

Ritchie, M.N. and You, H.Y. (2019). Legislators as Lobbyists. *Legislative Studies Quarterly* 65-95.

FERC Paper

US Veteran Census

#Notes:

1. Count letters by member by year (including zero counts)
2. Policy Stuff
3. Divide by years–annualized by years
4. Control with Gender–how long they’re in congress
5. Veterans–More likely to write, shared Veteran status. Veterans-gender-bias
6. What Kind of Variate Models??–Pro-business/anti-business/Constituent vs. everyone else/ Party Explanatory
7. Best way to present paper..like this or should I hide code??
8. Electoral Interests?–how to measure that?